Item-Type Field Guide

How Online Questions Look on Paper

STAAR is taken on a computer, so some questions ask you to do more than bubble a letter. This guide shows **every question type you may meet**, how we present it on paper in this book, and a quick example. The skill tested is always a Grade 8 TEKS skill — only the way you record your answer changes.

> **Key Idea:** On screen you *click, type, or drag.* On paper you *circle, write, or draw an arrow.* The thinking is exactly the same.

1. Multiple Choice

Online: Click one choice (A–D). **On paper:** Circle the letter of the one best answer.

Example (Math). Which number is the greatest? A. 0.6 B. ⅗ C. 0.58 D. ½ *(Answer: A)*

2. Multiselect

Online: Check every correct box. **On paper:** Circle **all** correct letters; the question says how many.

Example (Math). Select the **two** numbers that are irrational. A. √49 B. √10 C. π D. 0.25 *(Answers: B and C)*

3. Inline Choice (Drop-Down)

Online: Click a drop-down inside the sentence. **On paper:** Each drop-down is a box of choices; circle the correct one.

Example (Revising & Editing). The science club meets after school, and the members [is / **are** / was] planning a fundraiser. *(Answer: are)*

4. Text Entry / Griddable

Online: Type a number or short answer; for numbers you may fill a grid. **On paper:** Write in the box, then bubble the grid when provided.

Example (Math). A line passes through (0, 3) with slope 2. What is y when $x = 4$? [ ] *(Answer: 11)*

5. Drag-and-Drop

Online: Drag words/numbers from a bank into blanks or an order. **On paper:** A bank is printed; write each item on the correct line or draw an arrow.

Example (Math). Order from **least to greatest.** Bank: 0.4, ⅓, 0.37, ⅖ Least __ __ __ __ Greatest *(Answer: ⅓, 0.37, 0.4, ⅖)*

6. Equation Editor

Online: Build an expression/equation with an on-screen keypad. **On paper:** Write it neatly on the line.

Example (Math). Write an equation in form $y = mx + b$ for slope 3, y-intercept −5. _____ *(Answer: $y = 3x - 5$)*

7. Graphing

Online: Plot points, lines, or bars on a grid. **On paper:** Use the printed coordinate grid and a pencil.

Example (Math). On the grid provided, plot (−2, 4) and draw the line $y = x + 1$.

8. Hot Text

Online: Click a sentence or phrase in the passage. **On paper:** Underline, or write the number of, the sentence that answers the question.

Example (Reading). Underline the sentence that **best** supports the idea that the narrator felt nervous.

9. Written Responses (SCR and ECR)

Online: Type in a text box. **On paper:** Write in the lined space provided.

- **Short Constructed Response (SCR)** — a few sentences with text evidence (2 points).
- **Extended Constructed Response (ECR)** — a full multi-paragraph essay (10 points).

You will practice these in depth in the **SCR Mastery** and **ECR Mastery** sections.

> **Strategy:** When a question says "Select TWO" or "least to greatest," underline those words before you answer. Many points are lost not from wrong math or reading, but from missing the directions.

Your Study Calendars

Pick the plan that fits the time you have. Each uses the same four stages — **Learn, Practice, Simulate, Diagnose** — and spreads the eight full-length tests so you never cram. Check off each day as you go.

> **Key Idea:** Short, steady sessions beat one long rush. Aim for 30–45 focused minutes per study day.

The 4-Week Sprint (test is coming soon)

Week	Focus	Do This
1	Math — Strands 1 & 2	Read lessons; warm-up drills; take **Math Test 1**; review every explanation
2	Math — Strands 3 & 4	Lessons; drills; take **Math Tests 2 & 3**; fill diagnostic charts; redo weak skills
3	RLA — Reading + SCR	Genre guide & reading lessons; **SCR Mastery**; take **RLA Tests 1 & 2**
4	RLA — Writing + ECR, then finish	Revising/editing refresher; **ECR Mastery**; take **Math Test 4**, **RLA Tests 3 & 4**; final review

The 8-Week Plan (more time, deeper mastery)

Week	Focus	Do This
1	Math Strand 1 — Numerical	Lesson + drills; begin a daily routine
2	Math Strand 2 — Computations & Algebraic	Lesson + drills; **Math Test 1** + review
3	Math Strand 3 — Geometry & Measurement	Lesson + drills; **Math Test 2** + diagnostic chart
4	Math Strand 4 — Data & Financial Literacy	Lesson + drills; **Math Test 3**; reteach weak skills
5	RLA Reading — genres & strategies	Genre guide + reading lessons; hot-text practice

6	RLA Short Constructed Response	**SCR Mastery**; **RLA Test 1** + review
7	RLA Revising & Editing	Conventions refresher; **RLA Test 2**; **Math Test 4**
8	RLA Extended Constructed Response + final push	**ECR Mastery**; **RLA Tests 3 & 4**; final diagnostic review

Watch Out: Do not skip the review step. The biggest score gains come from understanding **why** you missed a question, then practicing that exact skill again.

Test-Day Game Plan

You have practiced the skills and the question types. Test day is simply one more practice test — this time for real. Follow this plan to stay calm and finish strong.

The Night Before

- Pack what you need and go to bed on time. Rest helps your brain more than last-minute cramming.
- Do a light review of your **diagnostic charts** only — no new material.

The Morning Of

- Eat a good breakfast. Arrive early so you feel settled, not rushed.
- Take a few slow breaths before you begin. You are ready.

During the Test — Your Pacing Plan

1. **Read the directions of each question carefully.** Watch for *select two*, *least to greatest*, and *best*.
2. **Answer the questions you know first.** Flag harder ones and return — don't let one question eat your time.
3. **Use your tools.** On Math, use the **calculator** and **reference sheet** and show work on scratch paper. On Reading, use the online **dictionary** when a word blocks understanding.
4. **Eliminate wrong answers.** Crossing out two choices doubles your odds on a tricky question.
5. **Never leave a question blank.** There is no penalty for guessing. Make your best choice and flag it to revisit.

Budgeting Time for Written Responses (RLA)

- Keep **SCR** answers short and direct — make your point, give **text evidence**, done.
- Save time for the **ECR** essay (10 points). A quick plan — thesis, two or three supporting points with evidence, a conclusion — keeps you organized. A partial, organized essay still earns points; a blank one earns none.

Before You Submit

- Return to every flagged question; make sure each has an answer.

- Check that multiselect questions have the **right number** of choices marked.
- Reread written responses once for clear sentences, correct spelling, and punctuation.

Key Idea: Finish every question with *some* answer, give the written responses real effort, and use your full time. Steady and complete beats fast and blank.

You've got this. Now turn the page and start building your skills.